

The Sunday Roast: The Great British Roast-Off [B1]

Se c'è una cosa a cui i britannici non possono rinunciare (e di cui vanno molto orgogliosi) è l'arrosto della domenica. Una gustosa tradizione che risale addirittura ai tempi di Enrico VII.



According to a 2012 [poll](#), the [Sunday roast](#) is the second thing Brits love the most about their country (the first is bacon sandwiches!) This is [hardly](#) surprising, given their love of nice [meals](#) and tradition. A more modest version of the Christmas dinner, the [Sunday roast](#) is the perfect excuse to [indulge](#) in some [yummy](#) food with family or friends, at home or in the pub.

BEEFEATING NATION

The most [widespread](#) version of the origins of the [Sunday roast](#) takes us back to the 15th century. It is believed that the royal guards of King Henry VII would enjoy a little [feast](#) of roasted [beef](#) every Sunday after church. This is why they came to be known as ‘[beefeaters](#)’. In the following centuries, the tradition spread to all the [households](#) that could [afford](#) it, and it became a Sunday [staple](#). Eating a large meal after the Sunday service was common all over Europe, and the roast variant prevailed in the British Isles. A Yeoman Warder (or Beefeater), one of an elite cohort of ceremonial guardians at the Tower of London. All Beefeaters are retired officers from the British Armed Forces with at least twenty-two years of service.

GOT A SPARE OVEN?

Traditionally, families prepared the meal before the Sunday service. The meat would be left to roast for hours, and it would be ready by the time they went back home after [mass](#). Then, vegetables such as potatoes and [turnips](#) would be added. The juices from the meat and vegetables would be used to make a [thick gravy](#) to [pour](#) over them. Not all [households](#) owned a [fireplace](#) to make their Sunday dinner, however, so some people took their ingredients to a local [bakery](#) to roast them there, while they attended church. Afterwards, they would pick their food up and take it home, just like an early version of a takeaway! Since it was a big meal, [leftovers](#) would be used to make [stews](#) and [pies](#) in the following days.

Culture

Britain's Cuisine: British Foods Expats Miss The Most Quando ci si trova all'estero, il ricordo di un piatto può bastare per evocare aria di casa... Quali sono i cibi che gli inglesi rimpiangono quando sono in giro per il mondo? Justin Ratcliffe

THE MODERN SUNDAY ROAST

Although meat is made in the [oven](#) nowadays and not roasted by the fire, the [Sunday roast](#) remains a powerful tradition. Many UK pubs offer it even on weekdays! The modern [Sunday roast](#) consists of a large piece of meat — it's often roast [beef](#), but it can also be [lamb](#), pork, or chicken —, with potatoes and vegetables, and of course some delicious [gravy](#). The most common [side dishes](#) for

the roast include Yorkshire puddings, sausages, and a variety of [sauces](#), like apple or [cranberry](#) sauce.

HOW DO YOU SAY...?

Il nocciolo della questione. The meat of the matter.

Glossary

- **feast** = banchetto
- **gravy** = salsa fatta col fondo di cottura della carne
- **fireplace** = camino
- **bakery** = panetteria
- **leftovers** = avanzi
- **cranberry** = mirtillo rosso
- **yummy** = gustoso
- **widespread** = diffusa
- **staple** = elemento fondamentale
- **pour** = versare
- **stews** = stufati
- **pies** = pasticci
- **saucers** = salse
- **poll** = sondaggio
- **Sunday roast** = arrosto della domenica
- **meals** = pasti
- **indulge** = concedersi
- **beef** = manzo
- **thick** = densa
- **lamb** = agnello
- **side dishes** = contorni
- **hardly** = appena
- **afford** = permettersi
- **mass** = messa
- **turnips** = rape
- **households** = case
- **oven** = forno